

Rui CHEN

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Research Interests

Human-Robot Interaction (HRI), Social Robotics, Affective Computing, Interactive AI Systems, LLM-based Interaction, Multi-Agent Systems

Education

Ph.D. in Social Informatics	Oct. 2020 - Nov. 2025
Graduate School of Informatics, Kyoto University, Japan	
Dissertation: Enabling Robots to Appropriately Use Negative Affective Strategies for Positive Impact	
Supervisor: Prof. Takayuki Kanda	
M.A. in Social Informatics	Apr. 2018 - Sep. 2020
Graduate School of Informatics, Kyoto University, Japan	
Exchange Student	Sep. 2019 - Feb. 2020
School of Computer and Communication Sciences, Ecole Polytechnique Federale de Lausanne (EPFL), Switzerland	
Coursework and research in Computer Science and Data Science	
B.Eng. in Information and Communication Engineering	Sep. 2012 - Jul. 2016
School of Information and Communication Engineering, University of Electronic Science and Technology of China, China	

Academic Experience

Postdoctoral Researcher	Dec. 2025 - Present
Human-Robot Interaction Laboratory, Kyoto University	
Research in human-robot interaction, including ongoing work on interactions between elementary school children and educational robots.	
Research Assistant	Oct. 2020 - Nov. 2025
Human-Robot Interaction Laboratory, Kyoto University	
HRI research and collaborative research with researchers at ATR / RIKEN.	
Teaching Assistant	Apr. 2024 - Jul. 2024
Information System Analysis, Kyoto University	

Publications

Journal Articles

1. **Rui Chen**, Takashi Minato, and Takayuki Kanda. "Wow, You're Really the Champion of the "Resting Competition," Huh?!: Robot Knows How to Use Irony Effectively." *ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction*, Vol. 15, No. 1, Article 14, 2026. DOI: 10.1145/3759157.
2. **Rui Chen**, Takashi Minato, Kurima Sakai, and Takayuki Kanda. "Meet the Motivational Robot That Predicts Your Future Feelings." *ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction*, Vol. 14, No. 2, Article 28, 2025. DOI: 10.1145/3707466.

Conference Papers

1. **Rui Chen**, Takashi Minato, Jani Even, and Takayuki Kanda. "Don't Say That! Proactive Support for Appropriate Power Use with Avatar Robot." In *Proceedings of the 21st ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI 2026)*, pp. 991-1000, 2026. DOI: 10.1145/3757279.3785646.
2. C. Yu, C. Fu, **R. Chen**, and A. Tapus. "First Attempt of Gender-free Speech Style Transfer for Genderless Robot." In *Proceedings of the 17th ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI 2022)*, pp. 1110-1113, 2022. DOI: 10.1109/HRI53351.2022.9889533.
3. **Rui Chen** and Shigeo Matsubara. "Improving the Accuracy of the Collective Prediction by Maintaining the Diversity of Opinions: Preliminary Report." In *Proceedings of the 33rd Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI)*, 2019.

Manuscript Under Review

1. **Rui Chen**. Manuscript under review for ACM/IEEE HRI 2027. First and corresponding author.

Invited Talks and Presentations

Invited Talks

**"Wow, You're Really the Champion of the "Resting Competition,"
Huh?!: Robot Knows How to Use Irony Effectively."** 2025

Invited Speaker, Center for Digital Media Computation, Xiamen University

**"Enabling Robots to Appropriately Use Negative Affective Strategies
for Positive Impact."** 2025

Invited Speaker, School of Future Technology, South China University of Technology

"Meet the Motivational Robot That Predicts Your Future Feelings." 2024

Invited Speaker, Center for Digital Media Computation, Xiamen University

Workshop Presentation

"Meet the Motivational Robot That Predicts Your Future Feelings." Oct. 2025

IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS 2025) Workshop, Hangzhou, China

Professional Service

Area Chair 2026

Late-Breaking Reports Track, ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI 2026)

Reviewer 2022 - Present

ACM CHI; ACM/IEEE HRI; IEEE RO-MAN; ACM HAI; ACM UIST

Member 2025 - Present

Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE)

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, C, Java, R, MATLAB

Robotics and AI: ROS, LLM-based Interactive Systems, Vision-Language Models (VLMs), Multi-Agent Systems

Data Science: Data Analysis, Data Visualization

Development Tools: Unity, Git, Linux

Languages

Chinese (Native), English (Professional Working Proficiency), Japanese (Working Proficiency)